INSIDE STLC ACADEMY

ISTQB FOUNDATION MASTERCLASS

Test Management Cheat Sheet

The planning, monitoring, control and risk essentials for the ISTQB Foundation exam.

Introduction

Test management covers how testing is planned, monitored, controlled and reported across a project. This cheat sheet condenses the syllabus Chapter 5 essentials into a quick reference you can revise in minutes.

Roles

Role	Responsibility
Test manager	Plans, monitors and controls testing; leads the test team and reports progress
Tester	Analyses, designs, implements and executes tests; logs defects

The Test Plan

A test plan documents the objectives, scope, approach, resources and schedule of testing activities. It defines what will be tested, how, by whom, and against which entry and exit criteria.

- Context and objectives of testing
- Scope, assumptions and constraints
- Test approach and techniques
- Entry criteria (definition of ready) and exit criteria (definition of done)
- Schedule, resources, roles and responsibilities

Entry vs Exit Criteria

Criteria	Meaning
Entry criteria	Preconditions that must be met before a test activity can start
Exit criteria	Conditions that must be met before a test activity can be declared complete

Estimation Techniques

Technique	Basis
Metrics-based (ratios)	Estimates based on data from past/similar projects
Expert-based	Estimates based on the experience of task owners or experts
Three-point / wideband Delphi	Combines expert estimates to reduce individual bias

Test Monitoring & Control

- Monitoring gathers information about testing progress against the plan.
- Control takes action to meet the plan (e.g. re-prioritising, adjusting scope).
- Common metrics: test cases run/passed/failed/blocked, defect density, coverage, effort.

Test Progress Reporting

Test progress reports (interim) keep stakeholders informed during a test period; test completion (summary) reports summarise a completed test activity, its results and residual risks.

Risk-Based Testing

Risk level = likelihood of occurrence × impact of harm. Risk-based testing uses risk to guide effort: higher-risk areas get earlier and more thorough testing.

- Product risk — a risk that the product may fail to satisfy needs (test object quality).
- Project risk — a risk related to management and control of the project (resources, schedule, suppliers).

Configuration Management

Configuration management establishes and maintains the integrity of testware and the test object through versioning, so tests are repeatable and results traceable.

Defect Management

Defects found are logged, classified (e.g. by severity and priority), analysed and tracked through to resolution. Reports feed monitoring and process improvement.

Best Practices

- Define exit criteria before execution starts.
- Prioritise testing by risk, not by order of features.
- Report progress in terms stakeholders understand.

Common Mistakes

- Confusing product risk with project risk.
- Treating the test plan as a one-off document instead of updating it.
- Reporting activity (tests run) without outcome (risk remaining).

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

> In the exam, remember the risk formula: risk level combines the likelihood of a problem occurring with the impact if it does. Any answer that ignores one of those two dimensions is usually wrong.